whatever it takes

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31845451.

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Explicit

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra), Octavia (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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theyre married, Action, Kidnapping, Alternate Universe - Medieval, princess adora - Freeform, duke catra, enby catra, Shadow Weaver Sucks, Magic, Smut, Pregnant Adora (She-Ra)

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by gaizotak

Summary

Catra and Adora are married and Adora has amazing news! that is until everything goes to shit and shadow weaver decides it's time to ruin their lives.

Adora learns what it means to be painfully patient and Catra has to fight for their life, as well as Adora's.

Can their bond save them and endure the pain?

Notes

tw// for toture. its canon compliant and i tried to be nice about it but yeah thats a heads up for shadow weaver being shadow weaver

See the end of the work for more notes

The room is lit by candles. A gentle glow that cakes the room in a soft shimmer with flickering flames that resemble Adora's fidgety fingers and the tip of Catra's tail. They are both post orgasm and cuddling in Catra's chambers— *their* chambers, now.

Their marriage had commenced and the two were quick to move to their quarters to make love. Hours have passed since then but neither are done; both are desperate for the other once again. They needed a break— needed each other. For hours they listened to their parents berate them for marrying without any thought of what the union between such lands would do to certain treaties and relationships across Etheria. But neither cared.

You'll marry who we say you will marry, and maybe then you will fall in love. Just look at me and your mother. We are happy together now.

What Adora's father neglected to tell her was how it took a decade for them to kiss after having 2 kids. Adam, her older brother, was a 'failed' child who lost his way at a young age and abandoned the kingdom and his duties, thus leaving Adora with the role to fill as the perfect child to make up for 'his' failures. When actually it was just poor parenting and never Adora's burden to carry, as Catra has come to teach her.

Whereas, Catra's mothers had already mated to separate lovers prior to Cyra taking the crown, but had to break those bonds in order to properly rule. It was excruciating and unfair, but once Cyra and Sasha both became Queens they revealed to have never broken apart from their first mates and have remained in touch, as well as remained in love and had several children of their own.

This has left Catra to feel illegitimate and seen as undesired as a child since they were a product of political means. Yet their mothers preach about not going after true love.

Cyra and Sasha claim to love Catra just as much as their other children, but it's hard to feel that way when both parents are happier when they are apart and lie about true intentions.

Catra and Adora want to prove everyone wrong and show that love can, in fact, win in the end. Hence, they show the kingdom just how bound they are to each other at the wedding with laughter and wet kisses. And don't hold back when they get to their bedroom.

In the bedroom, every climax ends with cuddles, then to roaming hands, roaming mouths— then the fire reignites. This time Adora strokes it's flame and leans over Catra and nuzzles their noses together. Both are beyond words as their senses fill entirely with one another and nothing else. Adora straddles Catra's hips as she cups their cheeks and kisses them deeply. She can feel their purr rumble through her body when their mouths connect. It's a soft and slow kiss as Adora settles to lay completely on top of Catra.

Catra instantly gropes and squeezes Adora's rear, lightly prickling it with their claws which make their wife giggle adorably. They giggle back and pull Adora's hips against their own, halting her giggles with a soft gasp and groan as she grinds again. Adora's bones are mush but the adrenaline of cumming with Catra once more gives her energy to keep going. Magicats are quite insatiable in bed, Adora has come to learn, and she is thankful for all of the training she does in order to keep up with Catra's stamina.

Adora feels Catra's hand trail around her thigh and to her burning center. Shivers go down her spine the closer they get and Adora raises her hips a bit more to give Catra access. Their fingers card through her curly mound then give her clit the gentlest ghost of a touch that has Adora burying her face in the pillow beside Catra's head. She's so sensitive from all of the sex they've had tonight but she just can't get enough, and thankfully, Catra understands and is soft with her.

Both of them have been drenched since they saw one another in their wedding attire. So, Catra slides 2 fingers in easily, making Adora moan right into their ear. Catra brings their other hand to brush Adora's hair off her sweaty neck so that they can kiss along the soft skin. Adora can't help but wrap her arms around Catra's head to pull their fangs to her pulse point for the hundredth time that night.

Slowly, *so* slowly, Catra pumps into Adora. The blonde leans her head back for Catra to sink their teeth in Adora's already bruised and claimed neck. The bite isn't like the other ones where Catra clamped down to the point of Adora screaming in pleasure. This one is soft and sweet, like a place to rest their tingling fangs to soothe one another.

At this moment Adora is entirely Catra's. They have been wedded, Catra has claimed her as their eternal mate with their fangs, and Catra holds her close as their fingers massage the inside of Adora's core. Her soul feels entirely melded to Catra's and she begins to glow again. She feels so safe and secure with her wife, her love. As much as she wants Catra to finger her faster, she

enjoys just feeling Catra inside her taking their time to love Adora.

Tears spring to her eyes from how happy she is. Her whole life she was raised to never have something like this. To marry for the world, never for love and for herself. Adora hears Catra sniff the air but they don't let go of her neck. It's not the first time she has cried tonight and Catra knows what to do.

They smoothly, without hurting Adora with their teeth and where their fingers remained within her, flip each other so that Catra is on top of Adora, grounding her as she works through the intense emotions. As she cries, Catra purrs and holds her close as they slightly pick up their thrusting pace. Adora speaks to Catra with her hips by rolling her pelvis to the rhythm she wants Catra to match.

Once her orgasm builds again, Adora moans louder and louder as Catra's teeth begin to sink in deeper and deeper. Soon, Adora is wildly thrusting her center harder onto Catra's soaking wet fingers. She's right at the peak and Catra brings the hand that's been stroking Adora's hair to flick her sensitive nub with expert speed.

Adora has always glowed when she climaxes, but *never* like *this.* She is practically dripping with magic and love as Catra takes her. Her body feels like a cloud as she floats through what feels like space, only to be tethered to Catra who brings her back to herself. She feels… new. As she comes down, she holds Catra close and notices how much more heavy they feel against her. How their fangs pulsate against her neck. Adora isn't sure what to make of it.

Adora is fucking exhausted now but she knows Catra needs to cum one more time. She flips them and kisses her way down Catra's body until she is nestled between their legs and inhaling their sex. Catra is utterly relaxed with their eyes closed, purring and holding onto Adora's hands without a care in the universe.

After a while of just enjoying Adora's tongue on their folds, Catra opens their eyes to check on Adora and sees a sight they immediately burn into their memory.

Her head is resting on their right thigh like a pillow as Adora holds with her wife's hands. But the best part is that Adora has her eyes closed, practically asleep. The slow licking of her tongue against Catra's dripping core is the only indicator that she is still lucid. She's just taking her time to drink up her lover and taste every ounce of them, softly moaning at the flavor with a small smile on her face.

Catra feels so worshipped, so loved, and they let Adora do whatever she wants to them. Eventually, Adora slips her fingers inside and begins to suck on Catra's clit, making them see stars for the 6th time that night. Mewls and stuttering purrs fill the room as Catra clamps around Adora's fingers and fills her mouth with their juices which Catra hears Adora readily drink up with loud gulps. The sound makes Catra cum again.

()()()

A week passes and Adora is headed back to their chambers after a day of speaking with the townspeople in Halfmoon. She is exhausted but all of her energy returns when she remembers the great news she has for Catra. The thought makes her giddy and she practically skips to their apartment in the back of the castle.

She busts in the door. “Catra!” she calls out and begins to search for her wife. Adora hears a rustling in the den and heads towards the sound with a smirk. She turns the corner to see her wife lounging on the sofa. “Hey,” Adora says warmly and gets a wicked grin in reply.

“Hey, princess,” Catra smirks and stands from the couch. Adora startles at how tall they are.

She chuckles, taken aback, “Hah, woah, when did you get so tall?”

Catra’s tail swings idly and the smirk turns into a large smile that reveals razor sharp teeth, rather than their typical fangs Adora loves so much. A sinking feeling hits Adora and she begins to shake with confusion.

“Catra?”

The figure turns black and inky before shifting into—

A hand clamps over her mouth and her arms are quickly being tied together in powerful restraints.

"Mmgghh!!!" Adora screams and grunts as she tries to bite at the hand around her mouth but the attacker has tentacles and the suction cups make movement painful and trifling.

The fake Catra has now morphed into a tall, slender chameleon with long blonde hair.

"Another wonderful performance by yours truly," the figure gloats and twirls their hair, sauntering up to Adora. She tries to scream through her muffled mouth and a large orc woman stomps into her vision.

"Fight back, and we will kill the Duke," she whispers in her ear with a chuckle. Her blood runs cold and she immediately stops struggling. Who knows how many other enemies there are and if they already have captured Catra.

Think, she pressures herself. Catra can handle themself. Guards are everywhere in the castle. The servants should be coming up to bring dinner soon. And the tailors—

A creak from the door draws everyone's attention. It's Catra.

Catra presses the apartment door open with caution before their whole body contorts into shock, fear, and then pure fucking rage.

()()()

Catra slips out of their meeting to head back to their apartment. Adora should be home soon for dinner and Catra wants nothing more than to nuzzle in their wife's neck. The meeting involved a lot of irritating negotiations with ignorant diplomats and Catra is *tired.* As they approach their door they pick up on a new scent—several actually. Their fur bristles and they pick up their pace to their apartment.

Opening the door hits Catra with three things.

One. Three figures have Adora immobilized. One of which they recognize immediately. An old war buddy that Catra thought was dead.

Two. Adora has tears in her eyes as she's being dragged out the window. Her arms bruised and hair a mess.

Three. There's a shocking smell in the room. Catra takes another sniff of the air and picks up on the new, small scent. It's coming from Adora. The last time Catra smelled such a peculiar scent was years ago when their aunt got pregnant with a new kitten.

No— it can't be— she's— they're taking away my wife and… and our unborn child?

Red fills Catra's vision as their claws unsheath, tail whipping straight out and mane growing in thicker and more coarse.

" *Hands off!"* Catra snarls with spit as they launch across the room in 2 massive leaps towards the kidnappers. Adora is staring at them with so much grief and conflict and Catra wonders why Adora isn't fighting back. Catra wants to let their inner beast out but they don't want to risk hurting Adora when she can't defend herself, so they settle for only releasing 40% of their mana into their form.

The white haired orc barrels in front of them, taking Catra's slashing attacks with her metal bracers defensively. It only makes Catra fight harder. Their tail is whipping wildly as they bounce against the attack, gaining ground towards where Adora is being dragged out of the window.

That's when Catra crouches and pounces for the ceiling, digging their claws into the woodwork and spider crawling to their wife. Once above the blonde, they leap down, only to be blocked, once again, by the shapeshifter who has now transformed into one of Catra's most trusted guards.

So that's how they got in, Catra realizes.

The chameleon throws up a shield which Catra bounces off of and leaps to the adjacent wall.

"Adora!" they holler and the sound shakes the room, making everyone briefly lose their balance.

It's a perfect moment to strike, and Catra takes it.

Adora is mere feet away but the orc and chameleon block their path. It looks like they will have to barrel through. They launch towards the two attackers— startling the woman holding Adora with her tentacles and thus losing her grip on their wife. As Adora fumbles from her captor's grip, she protectively clutches her stomach and the sight slaps Catra with a new wave of pure instinct to save their family.

The thought is enough to distract Catra and they are thrown off guard as massive shadows slither up their limbs and throw Catra across the room, knocking them unconscious.

The last thing Catra hears is Adora calling out their name with so much fear. " *Catra!"*

When they wake, their head is pounding. Their whole body feels like sand and it's as if their head is filled with clay. Getting their eyes open is a struggle as they fight for their sense of reality and awareness. After some grunting, they get their eyelids to flutter open and are met with a dimly lit room. They go to turn their head to see more but their muscles are so stiff from their poorly seated position to move without pain, making them hiss.

Movement to the left of Catra's vision sends a spike of anxiety to their bones and they try to move but realize they are bound to the chair they are sitting in. It takes everything in Catra to unsheathe their claws but their hands are bound away from the bindings so their claws can't reach. Catra snarls in confusion-- more movement and a chuckle that sets Catra's nerves on fire.

Catra wakes up a bit more from the adrenaline rush and remembers what happened. They came home to Adora being taken--- several assailants taking her away-- a scent--

Catra whimpers at the memory. *Adora is pregnant.*

More shadows and all goes black again.

()()()

Adora fumes in the back of the wagon she was tied up and thrown into. All she feels is anger as she goes over the sudden events of coming home, being attacked, watching Catra be knocked unconscious by a cloaked woman, dragged away, and then herself being pulled through a window and now in a wagon headed to who knows where.

"Where are you taking me?! What did you do to Catra?!" Adora nearly screams from the trunk she is tied up in. No response. New strategy.

If the bumps and scents of flowers are anything to go by, they are taking the eastern route from Halfmoon which is the most direct route back to Grayskull. If that is where they are headed, then why? Adora wants to test the strength of the trunk she is in but remembers how the assailants threatened to kill Catra if she fought back. Will they keep their end of the bargain?

Dammit, she wants to fight. To feel the power of She-Ra expand her muscles and explode out of the box but she thinks of Catra and their child. What would happen to their baby if she transformed? She… she can't risk either of their lives. Guess she is playing the waiting game… and the thought of that pisses her off immensely. It's a 2 week trip to Grayskull from Halfmoon at the speed they are going at and that only unsettles her more.

Adora begins to breathe heavily and it makes the box stuffy and hard to breathe in. It sends a wave of anxiety through her body as she fights for oxygen.

“Let me out, please! I need fresh air!” she calls out. There is grumbling but no answer to her plea. She tries again “Please… I’m feeling faint,” she says and it isn't a lie at this point.

A loud ‘gah!’ and dense shuffling before there is the obvious sound of a knife being pulled from its cover--

“I am with child!” Adora yelps in fear and all sounds stop. Even the carriage comes to an abrupt halt.

“What did you say?” A low voice asks and Adora can hear the trepidation in it.

She hopes that’s a good sign. A sign that she isn’t about to be killed or hurt in some way that could affect her baby. “I am pregnant with the Duke’s child. Do not harm me or you will regret ever agreeing to this job.”

Suddenly the cap of the trunk is yanked off and a cold blade is at her throat. But Adora is no longer scared. She stares back with conviction at her captor. She’s a large, buff woman with long white hair. “Listen, if you scream I will knock you out. Stay quiet, and I will leave you alone. Got it?”

Adora searches the woman’s eyes and only sees coldness. She nods and the blade retracts as the woman now uses it to cut a

large hole in the lid of the trunk. Then it's placed back over Adora, who gives an indignant huff, and the woman speaks again.

"I'm not going to be your friend. You are merely a delivery for me to make. You having a kid wasn't part of the deal so I'll be slightly nicer, but don't expect any royal treatment, your highness," the woman rolls her eyes and signals to the person with the horse reins to start up again. "I knew your scent was strange…. Guess having a hybrid child is harder to detect with you pure bloods."

Adora is happy to be breathing easier, but that relief lasts maybe 3 seconds. "You going to tell me who hired you?"

"Not your friend, remember?" the woman repeats and disappears from Adora's view.

She thinks of Catra and tries not to let the anxiety of Catra's well being consume her.

"But—" Adora begins but quickly shuts up when a harsh kick hits the trunk near her head and makes her yelp.

"Quiet!" the voice spits with irritation. "Or I gag you." The person sounds serious and Adora retreats into herself. Can she trust these people? What are they going to do to her? Is Catra safe?

“Damn, you are in a terrible mood, darling. What’s got you so wound up?” A voice— the shape shifter, Adora pieces together.

“That fucking magicat is what,” she growls and Adora’s heart rate picks up. “They and I have history. If it weren’t for our customer, I’d have killed them on the spot.”

A huff, “Cool it, Octavia,” the orc woman says. “You’ll get your chance once we turn her in.”

That sets Adora off. “You really think you stand a chance against Catra? They are one of the most skilled warriors in Halfmoon,” Adora laughs and can’t help how she smiles when she thinks about her wife. A rough kick to the box rattles her head.

“You—!” Octavia yells and rips the lid off, grabbing a grinning Adora by the chin, roughly. “You don’t know *shit* about your precious wife.”

“Watch it!” The orc barks and snatches Octavia’s hand from her grip on Adora. “She is to remain unharmed.”

“I wouldn’t hurt her where any one would notice. She is *She-Ra,* after all,” she explains but her partner isn’t having it.

The orc shakes her head, “Not risking it. We lose everything if we screw this up.”

Octavia scoffs, ”She’s pregnant! It’s already screwed up!”

“Oh my gooooooddddddd,” the shapeshifter whines from the front of the wagon. “You are both such drama queens!”

“You’re one to talk,” the women both mutter.

The orc sighs and rubs her temples. “Octavia, take the reins; DT, come keep the princess company.”

DT is more than happy to drop the reins and crawl into the back bench seats and props their head in their hands to look down at Adora. “My, you are gorgeous!” Adora can’t help but blush at the words.

“Uh-um- thank you,” she mutters.

“My name is Double Trouble, it is a pleasure to meet you,” they introduce themself. “The big woman here is Huntara and the one who wants vengeance is Octavia.”

They are acting so casual, like her family’s life doesn’t hang in the balance. Adora does not want to act like everything is fine. Nothing is fine and she still doesn’t have answers. “What did you do to Catra?”

“Us? Nothing,” DT answers with a terrifying grin.

“Where are they?” Adora nearly snarls. She’s becoming worried and down right pissed off. “You have me. You have our *child.* I am immobilized. Just-just tell me! I have to know!”

DT shares a look with Huntara, who shakes her head.

That’s when Adora feels a sharp pain in her head.

“ *Aaaahhh!!”* she screams and curls in on herself to lessen the stabbing pulse through her head. More so than the pain, she feels fear. Cold, dark fear swims in her veins.

“What the—“ Huntara startles and looks at her with annoyance and concern. “You good?” she asks when Adora feels the pain subside to a dull throb. The terror is still shaking her.

She blinks away the weariness that overcame her vision before responding. “What just happened?” Adora asks no one in particular. Maybe to her child, to herself, or to the gods above.

()()()

Catra wakes up screaming. It's like they're being burned alive from the inside out. They can't see, they can't make sense of anything but pain. Then it all stops and Catra slumps forward. If it weren't for the bindings, they would be a puddle on the floor.

"Hmmmmm," they hear a voice but Catra can't see who is speaking. Their eyes are too heavy to open and their brain feels like thick water.

"Ghhh," Catra tries to growl at whoever is doing this. A hand lifts their chin up and another pries their left eye open. Catra *hates* being manhandled— controlled and toyed with like this. They do their best to snarl and bite at the hands but the grip is too strong and it sends Catra into a state of panic.

"You're quite strong. But no one is unbreakable," the voice threatens. The hands disappear and Catra can breathe again and their thoughts become more clear as they listen to their footsteps retreat.

Catra takes this moment to absorb their surroundings. It's an empty room and Catra is set up in the middle of it. There's a massive gem floating about 10 feet before them. A table off to the gem's right is covered in potions and magic sand which is used for scribing spells.

That makes Catra look down to their feet to see an unknown symbol marked into the floor around their chair. Catra's blood freezes and their heart stops. This is forbidden dark magic. They wonder if Adora is ok— *Adora.*

"Where am I?" the Duke slurs and searches the darkness for the figure— there. They are cloaked and appear from behind the giant gem. Their face is covered and is swimming with shadows for hair. It's a woman— a tall one.

"Nowhere that you will remember here shortly," she says cryptically and rubs the red stone like a lover's cheek.

Catra huffs tiredly at that and feels some strength coming back to their muscles. "Yet you spark conversation. Get that lonely down here, huh?"

The woman is devoid of emotion thanks to her mask but there is amusement in her voice. "I think you should be more concerned about yourself than of my social life."

The hair on Catra's neck sits straight up. They are at a major disadvantage and the woman creeps closer. Catra is sure she is smiling this time. "Where is Adora?" they ask lowly and fight the shiver they get when the sorceress leans in real close.

"Your precious *Adora* is heading back to Grayskull right now." *What?* "She learned of your true colors and has decided to

abandon you.”

Catra rolls their eyes. “Yeah, sure. Adora’s favorite color is the rainbow; I highly doubt she has seen something she doesn’t already know about me.”

That makes the woman chuckle with confidence and patronization. Catra wants to claw at her throat and silence her. “You would be surprised at how easy it is to manipulate her.”

“What did you do--!?” they begin to snarl when two hands slap against their temples, sending Catra’s brain back into an excruciating frenzy. Catra hears one last sentence before all goes black again.

“No one will ever want you when I’m through with you.”

That makes Catra’s entire nervous system go into a frenzy. They need to protect Adora, need to warn her somehow, let her know that—

Catra’s vision goes black and they see is glowing blue eyes. Then the voice speaks, like it’s melding with their brain.

Catra, I will do whatever you ask.

()()()

Adora can’t help the sob that jolts through her when the pain returns much stronger this time. She hears people yelling and shuffling things around. The lid is thrown back over the trunk in a futile attempt to muffle her sounds.

“Gag her, dammit! It’s scaring the horses!”

“Shut her up while I get wood-- night is within the hour!”

“Make Octavia do it, she wanted to so badly earlier!”

“DT!” A voice barks and it sounds distant now but Adora can’t stop the lava that threatens to bust out of her head enough to care. Light peers into the box again.

A wad of something soft, possibly cloth or canvas, is shoved into her wailing mouth.

“Hush, princess, or the nightly beasts will find us.” That only makes Adora scream harder, which is easy to do, because she wants all of these people to pay for what they have done and finally leave her alone so she can see her wife again. Return to the happy life they had been building.

The pain finally subsides again after a couple more moments and Adora goes limp with exhaustion as she pants through her nose to fight off the nausea and dizziness. She wants to sleep so the pain will stop but she can’t give up on her escape and finding Catra. She fakes sleep easily and feels the box she is in begin to move. The temperature changes and there is a glow-- a fire. It’s warmth is agonizing against her throbbing skull but pleasant against the cooling air.

“Alright, what’s going on with her,” Huntara whispers angrily.

A suck of gums from Octavia, “How am I supposed to know? You’re leading this coalition and the only one who has spoken to Shadow Weaver.”

Shadow Weaver?

DT sounds pained. “I feel like we are missing something here; because no one screams like that, even for theatre, darling. That was real.”

"You think it's because of the kid?" Octavia asks and they all sit quietly for a moment. Adora wants to cradle her stomach at the mention of her child.

A growl rumbles from Huntara. "Look, all Weaver said was to take her to Grayskull like her parents asked."

My parents wanted this?

"She said nothing about the baby and random screaming. I don't know anything else. She didn't say and I didn't ask. Not when she showed me how much money we were getting out of this to stay quiet and be quick."

Adora does her best to not shake with anger and confusion.

She hears a flop and a whine. "Too bad those sleep spells don't work on First Ones. This is going to be a long trip."

"If we knocked her out, we wouldn't have learned about the child," Huntara points out but Octavia disagrees.

"If we knocked her out we wouldn't have had to deal with the child and could play dumb and let it be someone elses problem," she says and her voice turns almost cheerful. "But… that will just make whatever happens that much more amazing when I get my revenge on Catra."

“You never did tell us the story there. Care to share?” DT asks with interest.

Octavia groans but relents. “We were war buddies during the Overthrow of Thaymor. When Catra learned it was a town of innocents, they pulled out. But they neglected to tell my party about that and we were easily ambushed and defeated. They forgot about us and went back to sitting on their throne like we weren’t pawns. It’s how I lost my eye. We fought long enough for the townspeople to flee.”

Adora wants to scream again but her throat is drier than sand thanks to the gag and settles for kicking at the trunk.

The lid is pushed off and she is being glared down at by Huntara. “Got something to add? Speak above a whisper and you’ll be sorry.” She removes the gag and Adora coughs for the fresh air and is thankful when Huntara gives her some water to drink.

Sitting up, Adora glares at Octavia who looks at her boredly.

“Catra did no such thing.”

The woman rolls her one eye. “You weren’t even there--”

“I was!” Adora whisper shouts and that makes everyone look at her with surprise. “My kingdom, we received a letter about Thaymor’s innocent people being rumored as enemy territory to make us attack. We prepared a messenger to send word to you and Catra’s troops to pull back and lead the people to the Snow lands for safety. But Plumeria was attacked and we had to deviate our forces. If we lost Plumeria, we lost the protection of the Whispering Woods. And with that gone we would be open on all sides to attack. It was a decision to protect a town of hundreds or save the lives of millions and several kingdoms from the Horde.

“I was ordered to stay in the kingdom as the war deviated to the new threat. That’s when I saw the messenger leave ahead to Plumeria with letters of notes on troop numbers and supplies that we could aid them with. There wasn't anyone to spare to send to Thaymore. Not when this new attack meant the whole war. So, I took our fastest horse, Swift Wind, and rode to Thaymore to warn you all. Halfmoon’s army was divided on which land to protect. Catra was already on their way to Plumeria with Halfmoon under doctrine to back them up, no matter the situation. They had no choice. Their power of the Mahk’klaw was essential for the victory. So when I got there, I ordered half of the magicats to go to Plumeria, and the others to follow me to Thaymore.

“With She-Ra and Swift Wind on their side we could handle it. We flew over the forest and saw a trail of bodies. They were all messengers of Halfmoon from Catra’s forces. They did try to warn you, but were led right into a trap. There was nothing I could do for them so

I went on ahead and cut the time in half to get there with flight and began evacuating civilians as your troops fought. I took on as many soldiers as I could to protect the people of Thaymore until the Halfmoon forces arrived to escort them to a safer location. By

the time I could back you up, the fight was over and the town was ransacked. I… if there is anyone to blame, it's me."

Everyone looks at her in shock, then to Octavia. She's speechless and fuming. Adora is still angry from that day. She lost Swift Wind that day in Thaymor and her kingdom was sent into debt from the taxing required to protect the people when their military defenses depleted.

"It's my fault," Adora says again and that makes Octavia twitch.

"Say that again and you'll never come out of that box." Octavia spits

"Fine. But everything I said is true. Catra didn't abandon you."

She shakes her head and stares into the fire. Adora can't imagine the conflict she must feel when years of vengeance have been the only thing fueling your soul just to be extinguished in minutes.

Breaking the silence, Huntara says, "I remember that fight. Everyone was so focused on Plumeria that they didn't see the slaughter happening in Thaymor. Damn Horde scum," she says through clenched teeth.

"Darling," DT begins, "If what you say is true, then no one is at fault for this but the Horde." The seriousness and sincerity of their

words is puzzling, but Adora agrees. As much as she holds guilt over the event, she can’t help but nod when all of this would have been avoided without the senseless killing and extremist ideals of the Horde.

The rest of the night remains quiet as they eat and go to sleep--one person taking watch every 3 hours. Adora doesn’t sleep. Instead she thinks of Catra and if they are safe. And why she felt such intense pain.

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Catra has never been more uncomfortable in their whole life. They've been tied to this chair for over 48 hours at this point with no food. Just a few drinks of water. With the sorceress gone for so long, Catra tried to break free and transform but to no avail. Something is draining their power. Maybe it's the onslaught against their head. They still don’t know what this woman is doing to them.

It’s possibly an attempt to drain them completely of their magic which is making transformation impossible. They try using their tail to wipe away the magical symbol beneath them but it doesn’t budge.

Catra still doesn’t know who those blue eyes belonged to but it wasn’t Adora’s. These eyes were foreign but frighteningly familiar. They try to reach out to them, but get no response. Just a low hum. The Duke growls in frustration just as the woman returns. She immediately sets to preparing the spells all over again.

“What happened to Adora?” Catra demands for the three hundredth time and revels in the obvious annoyance it brings to the woman.

But she still doesn’t answer— only sighs and walks over to stand right in front of Catra, her hands covered in glistening liquid. Then her demeanor changes and Catra can hear the smile in her voice when she speaks. “You want to know what happened? Adora isn’t yours anymore. You have lost her.”

Catra shakes their head at the obvious mind trick. “She and I are mated for life.”

“Anything can be broken.” And when her hands clamp around their head again, they get a lot more than just pain.

This time they see Adora. Flashes of their life together. Every laugh, lunch together, mornings spent in bed as they talk about anything but their duties.

It all stops and the woman hums to herself as she comes back into Catra’s vision.

“A beautiful life, I must say.”

That pushes Catra to their fucking limit. “You are peeping into our private life?! You fucking low life!” they scream as their blood boils, fighting helplessly against the restraints. “Curse these stupid binds—- I’ll end you!”

The woman laughs loudly and heads back to the table. “When I said I’d break you, I wasn’t fooling you. I will render you a worm to society. Your Adora will want nothing of you after this.”

The process begins again and this time there is a tug at the back of their brain stem.

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“Is she having a seizure?” Octavia begs the question as Adora writhes and moans in the box.

“I don’t know, but I don’t like this any more. DT,” Huntara snaps her fingers in a direction for a dagger next to her bag. They hand

her the knife and she begins cutting a piece of leather off her satchel strap. “Help me open her mouth—“

“Um, *gross*—“

“Help or she’ll bite her tongue off,” she barks and then gets to work. Adora feels them grab her head and begin to pry her mouth open. She can taste the blood on her tongue from how hard she’s clenching her jaw but can’t make it move.

Huntara uses bruising strength as DT slips the folded up leather between her teeth. “It’s in!” they signal and Huntara releases her face.

“Spirits, what’s going on back there?” Octavia asks and Adora feels the carriage move a bit faster.

“This is getting out of hand,” DT says and furrows their brows.

Leaning into Adora’s hazy vision, Huntara asks, “Hey, you with us? What’s going on?”

Adora is seeing minute moments of her life with Catra. Why? What is going on? Is it because they are apart? Are they being attacked? Trying to reach her somehow? She can only whimper when the bombardment of pain and memories finally cease.

It takes her a while to catch her breath again and when she does, she spits out the leather and wobbles to her feet and glares as Huntara. She is doused in sweat and tears as blood dribbles from the corners of her mouth, but she undoubtedly represents command and power.

"You mentioned someone's name the other night. *Who is Shadow Weaver."*

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They are numb to the bone. Four sessions of this bullshit over another 2 days has Catra reeling and writhing in their chair. The pull in their brain stem is the only thing they feel and they focus on it to stay conscious.

Catra still isn't sure why this is happening and what for. Then their ears pick up on some of the woman's muttering.

"You'll remember nothing. I'll make sure of it. Adora will be *mine."*

That gives Catra something to work with. “Where am I? Wh-what’s goin’ on?” they slur and mewl, putting up a show. The slur is real; their magic being stolen this much has made them practically a husk of a person.

“It seems it’s finally happening,” she says to herself. “What month is it? Do you know?”

Now, do they say months prior to Adora? Their title? Wedding? If so, how many?

“Sept-September? No… the leaves haven’t changed yet…. Who are you?” Catra wants to high five themself because this old bat is buying it.

“Almost,” she says and Catra feels her hands on their face again. More memories flash and stutter before them. But this time, they focus on the tug in the back of their head with every ounce of brain power they can.

What is it?

More visions, much more intimate ones, their wedding day. The tug gets stronger when they hone in on that specific day. Catra thinks of the love they made, how they connected in ways neither thought possible.

Their brain is burning with urgency at that. They narrow down to the sex and kissing, being inside one another, when Catra claimed Adora and their wife began to glow brighter than ever and her hair began to swim and Catra felt their body thrum with life-- no, a new life—

Our baby. It's our baby.

The woman pulls back again and regenerates her power from the stone. Catra is drooling from the pain but they can't give up. Not when they are so close to the end of this mess. The woman returns and this time around, Catra sees the night they and Adora met. The instant connection and then sneaking off. *She wants me to forget Adora,* they finally realize and it all makes sense. She is trying to erase their memories but that threatens the magical link to Adora. The only thing keeping everything intact is their child.

It's finally over, or so Catra's tormentor seems to think.

"What is your status?"

Catra doesn't move or respond, merely swivel their ears in question. Then a hand pulls their head upwards to face her.

"What is your status in Halfmoon?" she asks with more clarity in her voice.

With bleary eyes, Catra murmurs, “What do you mean? I’m… I’m the soon to be Duke of Halfmoon. Everyone… knows… that….” they breathe out the last words and truly do feel the sleepiness of it all hit them like a brick.

The woman chuckles darkly. “Perfect. Now… just a couple more times to be sure.”

Catra squeezes their nails into their palms in preparation.

Catra loses track of time once the woman pulls her hands away for the 3rd time. They have no idea how much time has passed. All they know is that they haven’t slept for a long time.

The woman leans in again but there is no pain this time. Actually, Catra is paralyzed. It sends anxiety through their system but they fight to play it cool and the woman ragdolls them off the chair, out of the restraints, and into a wagon.

The wheels thump over the cobblestones of the dungeon before a bag is thrown over their head as they enter sunlight. Catra can’t make out what time of day it is through the burlap sack.

Catra hears a river and smells the types of wildlife and plants around them. It smells like… Plumeria. Or at least close to it. At least an hour passes before the wagon stops and Catra is being thrown into a puddle of mudd.

They groan and feel the bag come off. When they open their eyes, no one is there, not even the wagon. It takes a while for Catra to get feeling in their muscles again and are sentenced to lying in the wet, cold mudd for a long while.

But soon, they get feeling back and the need for food overtakes their senses as they sprint to the nearest village, albeit clumsily, to get some meat and potatoes from those who recognize them as the Duke. But… they get some nasty looks in the process. They think it's because they smell. As Catra leaves, they snag a newspaper to get caught up on things and ask a passerby what day it is.

When they reply, they do it with a disgusted look and continue walking. Catra furrows their brows at the reaction and assumes it's because they don't know who they are. *11 days have passed,* Catra notes and thanks the civilian. It's 9 days too long away from Adora.

Catra finds a seat behind a band shed and flips over the newspapers as they eat and drink, trying to make their brain stop spinning but not wanting to waste any time.

On the front page is Catra's portrait and takes in the information following the image. Their organs turn cold.

The Duke of Halfmoon to lose their title. Protests rise for justice from unlawful taxation of a selfish ruler. The people of Halfmoon have been lied to and demand correction and imprisonment towards the Duke. Princess Adora filed for divorce and nullification of their two kingdoms only three weeks after marriage.

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“A dark sorceress?” Adora asks with a bit of anxiety. DT nods.

“I’ve heard lots of talk about her abilities.”

Adora feels her lip quiver. “What kind of abilities?”

“Types of magic that are considered taboo and worthy of prison, darling,” they say sadly and Adora is glad she is already sitting or she would have fallen over. “I don’t know what she is doing to them, but…”

Bile rises in her throat but she bites it down just before another round of pain hits her again. And this time, it is relentless.

After a bit of time the random bouts of pain finally cease and Adora feels almost empty by the time they get to her kingdom. Adora feels so empty and it worries her that Catra is in danger. But she shakes those thoughts away and tries to escape. To get back to Catra and be with their love.

She waits until they are all asleep. A week's worth of captivity has to have given these guys the idea that she isn’t going to run. Little do they know she has been plotting with every waking moment.

DT is a surprisingly hard sleeper, while Huntara snores quite a bit, but Octavia is incredibly alert even when asleep. All three take shifts when sleeping so one person has their eye on Adora.

Every scenario ends with Adora getting caught and bound even tighter. But what she didn’t account for? To be followed.

For at least 2 days they have been followed by… something. She doesn’t think it’s a person. Not with how the eyes glow. But she pushes that sense of hope to the side and let’s adrenaline course through her and guide her.

She is still scared to use She-Ra for the sake of their child, but that doesn’t mean she still isn't strong enough to bust out of this damned box. Lying on her back, Adora puts her bare feet to the roof of the box and pulls her knees to her chest and prepares to crush it open with an explosive kick.

Mew .

Huh?

Mewwww.

Adora pulls her feet back and relaxes her muscles. She scoots and turns herself to the side so she can peer outside the box handle holes. It's dark out, but she can clearly see those spooky, yet calming eyes looking at her.

"Hello?" she whispered softly."Why are you following us?"

You.

That made Adora jolt. She heard the word like a thought but it wasn't her own. It came to her like blinking into the morning. Sudden and sharp, but clear and obvious.

"Following *me?"*

Yes.

“Why?”

Catra.

Adora feels tha tinge of hope within her reignite. She wants to bite it down but she just can’t.

“You know my Catra? How? Who are you?” she asks rapidly, softly, so Huntara, who is on watch, doesn’t hear.

In times of great distress, a magicat will connect with a krytian, which is a distant ancestor of the Magicats. We Krytians only reveal and link with our partner when we are most needed.

“Does this mean Catra is in danger?”

Yes, but they will be fine, because they have you two. But you must stay safe.

“What’re you getting at?” Adora asks with so much confusion and uncertainty. Why can’t she run to her love and save them? How is it that they must remain apart in order to be safe?

Catra is strong and will be fine. They know where you are headed and where you will be. Deviate from this course and you could lose one another.

"But our link? Can we not find each other that way?"

No. Adora, you must remain with these people. I will continue to protect you all as we travel. All Catra wants is for you to be safe.

Adora's heart flutters with warmth. "If… this is the best plan, then I suppose so. Wait— what do you mean 'you will continue to protect us all'?"

The night beasts. They are a notorious threat. I have dealt with them.

That makes a lot of sense. Adora hasn't seen any in the last few days. "Thank you. What is your name?"

Melog.

"Thank you, Melog," Adora says and smiles. As long as Melog is here, Catra is safe and Adora will be as well. She must hold faith in that.

The next several days pass in a blur and Adora's bones ache from being in the box. She misses Catra and is sick of waiting, but every night she sees Melog and it calms her.

As they approach Castle Grayskull, Adora fills with rage that her parents would literally have her kidnapped. That something potentially terrible would happen to Catra in the process.

DT snips the binds around Adora's feet and hands, but Huntara keeps a firm grip on her upper arm as she is led into the kingdom. Adora has been reciting her livid speech to her parents for days now and when they come into view, everything dies in her throat.

"Adora!" Both her parents cry and run to her, enveloping her in a hug.

"Um--?"

"I'm so sorry, Adora. This must be so hard for you," her father whispers and strokes her hair. Her mother holds her close with apologies spilling off her tongue.

"What's going on?" Adora demands a bit too harshly, but she is so annoyed. Her parents pull back and look at her funny.

"Sweetheart… the divorce…" her mother says slowly. That makes Adora pause and turn to look at Huntara, DT, and Octavia.

They look just as confused. She faces her parents again and tries to smile.

"Right! Um, sorry the trip was long and I'm very tired. I would like to go to my room and rest." And speed walks towards her room. "I am not to be disturbed!" And bursts into a sprint when she turns the corner.

She slows back down to a walk when she makes the last corner so the guards she knows are at her door don't see her in a frenzy. She nods to them and they open her door there and latch it behind her.

Melog crawls in from the window, much larger than Adora last saw them, and she can now see them in greater detail. She can feel Catra in their presence and rushes to them, hugging them tightly around the neck, praying Catra can maybe feel it. *Catra.* They are probably injured and need medical supplies or hungry and thirsty and need new clothes before they go back to Halfmoon.

Not a moment later she is packing a bag and plotting her escape. That's when there is a knock at her door.

"I said I don't want to be disturbed!"

“Hey, we should talk.” It’s Huntara.

Adora feels her anger rise. “You are the last person I want to speak with!”

Huntara sighs. “Please, hear me out. We all want to make this right.”

We.

“Enter,” she says but doesn’t stop her packing. Three sets of feet scuff into the room and then stop. Only then does Adora turn to face her three captors. “Why are you all still here anyway? The job is done and you can go collect your payment.”

Shockingly, Octavia steps forward. “Our job isn’t done.” Adora looks at her to keep going. “Once Shadow Weaver is done with Catra, she is going to… come here.” The princesses hands begin to shake and she looks to the others for confirmation. They all nod. She turns back to Octavia.

“When?”

“I don’t know. We were going to stay hidden in the kingdom to make sure you didn’t leave, but we changed our minds.” That gives Adora a bit more hope. Because she isn’t sure she can

harness the power of She-Ra right now thanks to the pregnancy. She instinctively rubs her stomach and it makes her eyes burn.

"What's the plan you had in mind?"

Huntara speaks up and says, "Octavia is going to Halfmoon. Shadow Weaver has really soiled Catra's reputation over there since we left. She is going to clean that up. DT will be hidden among the guards and keep an eye out for Weaver. But as for me, I will be your personal bodyguard for the time being. I don't know what Weaver has planned, but it's not good."

DT rolls their eyes. "I do *not* like this. Would much rather stay out of this… so I expect something in return."

Fiercely, Adora nods. "Name it, you got it. I just need Catra to be safe. I want all of this to go away. Something bad has happened to them, I know it." Then Adora remembers the mention of the divorce. "Explain why my parents think I am divorcing Catra. And what is this talk about Catra's reputation?"

An excited squeal from DT, "Oh, *honey."*

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Catra climbs to the top of a large tree and scouts the area. After a couple moments they get a sense of where Grayskull is and jump down on the ground in a four legged sprint to their wife. They're starving and running on fumes as they get the hang of their body again.

Their magic is slowly coming back to them but not enough to transform. Every part of them is so weak and thin. It doesn't take long for them to slow down and look for food and water to regain their strength.

When Catra's head stops spinning, they begin running again. And they run until the sun is touching the horizon line and they keep running until they pass out in some bushes.

Cracking their eyes open sends Catra into fight or flight, leaping from the random bed they have been tucked into and scanning their surroundings for a door— some way out.

"Settle down, dearie!" an old voice yells. "You'll pass out again if you aren't careful."

Catra follows the sound to see an old woman with massive gray hair stirring a pot. "Where am—" Catra begins to ask but the adrenaline wears away and the dizziness from standing up too fast hits them, knocking them back down into the bed.

The woman waves her spoon. “Stay right there! Lunch is almost ready! I’m sure you are hungry after sleeping for two days!”

Catra slept for two days?! “I need to go—“ they say and go to get back up when a broom smacks their face, making them hiss and swipe with their claws.

“You are in no shape to move, dearie.”

They snarl. “Listen, old bat, there’s someone very important that I need to—“

“Yes, but first— eat!”

“Stop interrupting me!” Catra bellows as their tail flails behind them. “I have to save—!”

“Adora, yes, I am aware,” the woman says plainly, completely ignoring Catra’s livid responses.

Hearing their lover's name makes Catra calm down a bit. “You know Adora?”

“Madame Razz knows all She-Ra,” the woman, Madame Razz, stated simply as if everyone should know that. “Now eat this soup or you’ll never get to her in time!”

That scares Catra. The thought of not being able to protect Adora shakes them. “Fine.”

And the two eat together, Catra much more savagely than Razz. They don’t slow down until their third bowl of roast. “Now, isn’t that better?” Razz asks and Catra grumbles.

“Now can I leave?”

“Not yet!” Razz shouts rather cheekily and Catra’s growl dies in their throat when the woman whistles, long and loud, making their ears flatten. “Swift Wind!”

Then a massive alicorn barrels into the tiny hut, knocking several things over. “Did somebody say—“

“Yes! Now listen up! The Duke here has to protect your rider, Princess Adora!”

The alicorn gasps loudly and sniffles. “Adora?”

Razz nods and packs a bag for Catra. “There isn’t much time. Catra, Swift Wind will fly you there—“

“Woah, wait, flying? No—“

“And you will get there in a matter of hours while you regain your strength! Now, get on the horse or Shadow Weaver will beat you there! You won’t make it on foot.”

That sends Catra into action. They bite back on their nausea and clench their fists to stop from shaking as they grab the backpack and climb on top of the horse.

“To Adora!” Swift Wind shouts and lurches into the sky, making Catra squeak. As they fly, Catra feels their body vibrate with energy. They suspect Razz spiked the roast because Catra hasn’t felt this empowered since they first gained the power of Mahk’klaw at 14 years old.

The two fly with little conversation for a while as Catra merely tells them where to go and what to look out for as they fight down the elevation sickness they are getting.

“So… your Adora’s wife, right?” Swift Wind asks timidly and Catra squints their eyes.

“Yes… what about it?”

“Has she never mentioned me?”

Catra thinks it over and realizes that he’s never come up. “Uh, I’m afraid not. How do you know her?”

The horse sighs. “Figures she forgot about me.”

Catra would dive more into it but they are more concerned about Adora’s wellbeing. The two lapse into silence.

Swift Wind looks ready to spark up conversation again when castle Grayskull comes into view. “Finally! Head straight for the castle!”

“On it!”

Swift Wind nose dives right into the front castle grounds. “Adora!”

Catra is quick to dismount and begins running through the castle, startling every guard who tries to stop them. “Let’s split up!” they yell to Swift Wind as spears and arrows fling past them.

“Intruders!” the guards yell and swarm the two.

But Catra is quick, and had plenty of time to recuperate on the ride here. Transforming comes as easy as breathing, but they don’t want to hurt anyone and make everything worse. As Catra dodged every attack they sniffed the air for Adora. She isn’t in her room or kitchen or training room. Every passing second sends Catra further into a spiral.

Then they hear Swift Wind. “Catra! To me! I think I found—“

His voice is cut off and Catra lunges down the corridors to his scent. “Swift Wind?” They call out and when they turn the corner they come to an abrupt halt as spears jab into their face. Catra barely manages to avoid them, leaning back with break neck speed and flipping over themself away from their reach. But they can't stop there, not when arrows wizz by them barely grazing their fur and mane. Catra shrinks back to their normal self to become a smaller target and leaps for the high ground advantage.

From above they get a good look at the action. Swift Wind is getting nets thrown over him and dives down to shred the lines and free him. “Come on noble steed!” they tease and that gets Swift Wind to move into action.

“She’s up ahead!” he shouts with a point of his horn in the direction of the war room. “Go! I’m right behind you!”

He doesn’t have to tell Catra twice and they leap back for the ceiling and scurry towards where Adora’s scent grows stronger.

Her scent is obscured with fear and panic. Catra's ears twitch at the sound of a struggle. They move faster and swing from the support beam to smash the doors open with their feet to reveal Adora and their captor from before.

The woman is trying to launch red electrical beams at Adora who is holding up She-Ra's shield. Adora has yet to transform. Catra hits the floor and sets on a dead sprint to their wife. The evil woman steps back and forces more magic into her attacks, beginning to overwhelm Adora as electrical spurts sneak around the edge of her shield, reaching for her face.

Catra.

It's the voice from before. "Help Adora! Please!" they shout. Catra transforms and everything slows down as their brain takes in more seconds than any normal being to assess the situation faster. They either take the blow or hit the evil bitch. "Get Adora! I'll take on the bitch," they decide and direct all of their momentum to the bitch, so Adora can have some breathing room.

"Adora!" Catra screams to get her attention that they have finally made it and pounces on the evil bitch. "And *you!"* They get their claws around her neck and go to squeeze the life out of her when two blinding stabs of pain slips between their ribs and puncture their right lung. Catra lets out a stone shattering yowl of pain and leaps off the woman to stand in front of Adora.

"Hey, Adora," they say thickly and pull the spear and arrow out of their side, struggling to breathe. The creature circles them and

growls at the evil woman.

“Catra!” Adora cries and cradles their larger body close with the shield out in front of them. “Are you okay? That woman-- is she the one who hurt you?” she asks with trembling rage as everyone comes to a standstill. The knights have weapons trained on Shadow Weaver who struggles to stand while the other guards still pounding into the room target Catra.

“Princess Adora! You must flee! The Duke is an enemy of Etheria and Castle Grayskull!”

“They are not!” Adora bellows and the knights cower at the shocking anger in her throat. “You will stand down and target the woman over there! She is a dark sorceress who must pay for her crimes of illegal magic and torture against the crown!” The knights can’t help but obey her commands and turn to Shadow Weaver.

Catra gags and coughs up some blood. Adora drops her shield to grab Catra before they crumble to their knees. “Stay still, my love, I will heal you.”

Just as Adora begins to work her magic and Catra feels some ounce of relief, Shadow Weaver fills the room with shadows. Everything is swallowed by the darkness as it wraps around everyone’s neck and face. “Catra, there are allies in danger in the main hall-- we have to help them,” Adora begs and Catra looks to their new companion.

“Go to them, we got this. Thank you for looking after her,” they tell them and the creature nods and vanishes.

“I will have you Adora,” Shadow Weaver muses and uses her shadows to throw the knights out of her path for a straight shot to where the lovers cradle one another. Adora continues to heal Catra as fast as she can.

“Catra, I can’t transform-- I’m pregnant-- it-- what if--” Adora stammers but Catra is quick to understand.This isn’t how she wanted Catra to find out the good news, but they have to know.

Catra can feel their lung tissue mending itself and stands up, transforming once again to completely shield Adora. “Stay behind me,” they order and grab Adora’s shield.

“Okay,” Adora gulps and continues to heal Catra’s wounds. “I got your back.”

Weaver jolts with an explosion and flies right up to Catra with a fist of electricity. Her fist slams into the steel with a loud pang as energy bursts from the impact against the shield. The force pushes the two rulers back several feet, nearly slamming into the wall behind them if it weren’t for Catra’s strength. Adora looks behind them to see how much distance there and she gasps.

“Catra! Behind us!” Catra looks back to see shadows crawling up the wall and preparing to strike Adora like a snake. They pivot on

their feet and swap the shield to their less dominant hand to take the blow but now their flank is wide open for Weaver to attack.

"NO!" Adora screams and turns into She-Ra on instinct, taking the next wave of electrical pulses straight to the chest. It knocks the wind out of her so much she can't scream.

Catra's ears start ringing at the sight of Adora being brutalized and is quick to wrap their tail around Adora's waist and pull her out of the line of fire to take the blow to their back. " *Aaaahhhh!!"*

That's when Adora does something Catra, nor anyone has ever seen before. She grabs the shield in her right hand and materializes a sword into her left hand. Not once has anyone see She-Ra make two weapons from the sword.

"Raaaah!" Adora grunts and flings the sword over her shoulder, catching Weaver's hands with the blade to absorb the electricity. Her muscles burn from both sides of crushing weight pressing in on her. "Catra?!" She looks to Catra to check on their well-being.

Catra's vision comes back and they waste no time lurching at Shadow Weaver with a massive kick that sends her soaring into the furthest wall, leaving a dent. The shadows stutter and die out but the bitch gets right back up. She stands up and removes her mask to reveal a marred face and devilish smile. With a laugh she pulls out a potion to drink and knocks it back then replaces the mask.

Her body begins to quake and rattle with red light as flickering shadows slither form her pores. The energy burns everyone's eyes, nearly blinding them.

"Adora! Catra!" several voices yell and it's Swift Wind with Huntara and Double Trouble on his back and Melog at their side. Without hesitation, the four charge the glowing woman, throwing spears as they go to keep her off balance.

Weaver leaps from side to side and closes the distance to Adora.

The two don't need to look at each other to know what to do next. Catra sucks in a heap of air and explodes a roar while Adora builds up energy in her sword and releases it towards Shadow Weaver who has nowhere left to run. Knights and archers block her right while Swift Wind and Melog charge on her left with Huntara and DT on her back as Catra and Adora take on her front. Everything clashes in on her, making her scream in agony, and the dark energy of the room vanishes-- the stone in her mask exploding with it.

Catra runs up to her body, checks her pulse, and sees that she is unconscious. They nod to Adora who orders, "Chain her, now!" When Catra sees the woman in cuffs and hauled away, they finally turn to Adora to see her back to her usual self.

They detransform as well and ran up to hug her close. "How's the kid?" they ask softly and get on their knees to rest their head on her stomach. Catra hears a tiny, beautiful wind of magic within Adora and they relax.

“Are they okay?” Adora asks with fear, cupping Catra’s face to look at them. Catra’s smile is the only answer she needs to know everything will be okay. She joins her wife on the floor and cradles them close. “Are you okay?”

Catra nods. “Yeah, yeah I'm okay. Are you?”

Adora nods with tears in her eyes and kisses Catra deeply. “More than okay. I was going to tell you when those people attacked me-- about the baby, I mean.”

Catra purrs into her neck. “I could smell your hormones when I walked in the door. I-- it’s all I've been able to think about since you were taken from me.”

“I’m here. I’m yours,” Adora reminds them and rubs their back to settle their nerves as well as her own. “What happened to you?”

Catra kisses her and pulls them back to their feet. “I’ll tell you all about it after we get this mess sorted out.” Catra wants to be alone when it comes to revealing so much vulnerability. Then turns to see Swift Wind with Huntara and DT in shackles. That enrages Adora.

“You will uncuff them immediately.” The knights startle at the tone in her voice and obey. Catra looks at Adora with questions and

sees the creature they linked with appear at their sides, purring as they nuzzle Adora.

"But aren't they the ones who…?" The blonde nods.

"After the mess, okay?" Adora pleads and looks to Swift Wind. Her eyes go wide and she smiles brightly. "Swifty!" And runs up to him, pulling him into a fierce hug. "I thought I'd never see you again, what happened to you? Where have you been?"

"Adora, I'm so happy to see you. I thought you didn't want to see me again…"

Adora pulls back, shocked. "What?"

"Our connection was severed at the Overthrow of Thaymor. I thought it's because you didn't need me anymore."

The princess shakes her head so hard that tears fall from her eyes. "Not at all! I took a blow to the head and when I woke up, you were gone. I-- I thought you were dead. I couldn't reach you at all. I looked everywhere for you."

"Oh," he sniffles and wraps his wings further around her. "When I couldn't find you, I stumbled upon a hut with an old lady named Razz, and that's where I met Catra and got us here."

Adora pulls back with a loud gasp. “Catra *flew here?”* And turns to smile like a goof at Catra who is blushing up a storm.

“They were *not* happy about that. Their claws were in my side the whole way here,” Swifty mutters and Catra scowls with embarrassment. “You married a feisty one.” Catra smirks with a fang at that.

Adora can’t help but laugh at the situation with a snort. “We have a lot to talk about.” Then she looks to Melog. “And thank you, Melog.” She hugs them and Catra bends down to rub their back, feeling the magical energy thrum within them and tingle through their fingertips.

“Melog-- is that your name?” A confirming mew. “You and I have a lot to talk about as well. But… thank you, most importantly, thank you for looking after my mate.” They nuzzle into the wives cheeks and shrink down to a size small enough to jump onto Catra’s shoulder.

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Everyone who is injured is sent to the infirmary where Adora heals who she can as Catra helps clean the rubble of the weapon room

to look for survivors. Eventually Adora and Swifty catch up on their lost time together and Catra learns about what Octavia is doing in Halfmoon to help them regain their status. Catra still wants to claw them to death for assaulting Adora but they keep it together and thank them for protecting her when they couldn't.

Then they speak with Adora's parents and she learns that her parents didn't organize any of this. That it was Shadow Weaver manipulating everyone all along in order to selfishly harness the power of She-Ra for the Fright Zone. To isolate her. It's a lot to take in and Adora doesn't let go of Catra's hand the whole time.

Soon, the two royal lovers are curled up in Adora's chambers. Catra's head rests on Adora's sternum as they rub her abdomen, purring softly as Adora cards her fingers through their mane. Melog and Swifty guard the door to their room.

"It was terrible, what she did to me," Catra admits, finally opening up after a couple hours of snuggling. Adora holds them closer and kisses their hairline. "Woke up, strapped to a chair and depleted of magic. My power was gone and I couldn't break free." Adora knows how much Catra hates being tied down and controlled like that; how much that scares them and she soothes them with scratches behind their ear-- reminding them she is here, they are both safe and alive. "She was trying to wipe my memories of you. She tried for several days but never did. I played dumb and acted like it worked. She—she—" Catra stutters and begins to tremble.

Adora holds them close with worry. "Take your time, my love. You don't have to say it now if you don't want to. These last couple weeks have been so much," she assures them and Catra relaxes a bit. Despite this, Catra shakes their head.

“I don’t want there to be secrets between us, Adora.” They scoot up to further bury their nose in Adora’s pulse point and wrap their tail around her ankle and tangles their legs with Adora’s. “When she was wiping my memories… she… she saw our life together.” Catra holds tighter when they feel Adora gasp. “She saw everything and tried to erase you from me.”

Catra is crying now, and Adora is soon joining them as they cling to each other.

“I’ll make sure she never sees the light of day again,” Adora declares with such ferocity and anger that Catra falls more in love with her. They love her fighting spirit. It’s what made her such a renowned She-Ra.

“I know you will, baby,” Catra says with kisses to Adora’s neck and cheeks. “But do you know why she failed?” Catra asks and looks down at Adora with a small smile.

It fills Adora with warmth; extinguishing the rage she felt before. “How?”

“Our baby. She couldn’t sever our link because of our baby. Cliche, right?” Catra snickers but it’s full of love and exasperation.

Adora snorts and cups their cheeks, brushing the fur there with her thumbs. “So our love was ‘unbreakable’?” she asks with a cocky grin, quoting Shadow Weaver.

“Yep. The witch really thought she was going to tear a Magicat and First One apart. Even without the baby, I would still find my way back to you.”

“I know you would,” Adora agrees and pulls Catra to lay on top of her again. “She really hurt you, though.”

“How do you know that?” Catra asks softly.

Adora debated not telling Catra, but they have a right to know. It’s honesty hour apparently. “While I was in the wagon I kept getting flashes of pain, so much pain.” She feels Catra growl but Adora knows it’s not directed at her. “I felt everything.”

Catra holds on to her like a vice. “That bitch,” they snarl. Now they both really hate Shadow Weaver. Adora mentally notes to strengthen the prisons while Catra is going to do more security logs of the knights throughout the kingdom.

“I doubt she knew what was happening. But it wasn’t pleasant. All I could think about was if you were okay. Seeing me in pain made Huntara and everyone change their minds about the job. They learned about the war and the truth of what happened at Thaymor.” Adora looks down at her lover with a warm smile.

“Learned how much we mean to one another and the life we created.”

Purring fills the room as Catra nuzzles in closer to Adora. “I still despise them for treating you that way. If anyone could change a criminal’s mind it would be you, princess.”

“And thank you for sending Melog. They were a huge comfort to have there with me.”

Catra blushes. “I didn’t know I could do that, but I’m glad they were there for you. It settled me knowing you had me there in some way to look after you and the baby.”

“I don’t ever want to be apart like that again,” Adora tells them with a kiss to their hairline.

“Me too. I’ll do thorough checks of our knights in Halfmoon and make sure to speak with the people about the recent events of my reputation.”

Adora nods. “You won’t do it alone. I’ll be there and we will announce the pregnancy too.”

Catra cups her cheek and looks at her with wide eyes. “Are you sure? You want everyone to know, I mean.”

“Yeah. This baby is a hero, after all,” she says with a big smile.

Catra rubs her stomach. “Damn right they are.” And kisses her abdomen and then pecks Adora on the lips. “Tired?”

“Yeah,” Adora says with a yawn. “I could sleep for a year after all of this.”

Catra removes their outer wear and strips down to their trousers as Adora does the same. They both curl under the sheets and hold one another close. “I love you, Adora. I always will.”

“I love you, too, Catra. Forever and always.”

They each take a deep breath of the other one's scent and know they are safe.

End Notes

thank you for readingggg. I hope you all enjoyed! this was a blast to write and was a beast to keep track of everything going on. i hope all of the plotting was cool, ive been working on my element of surprise in my fics for **drama**.

tried to keep everyone in character as much as possible with regards to their different upbringings in this au.

see you at part 3 sometime next week!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!